

Name: _____

Class: _____

Date: _____

Book Worksheet 1

What Is a Computer?



Read: Introduction · The Personal Computer · Memory and Storage

The History of the Computer · Rachel Ignatofsky · Pages _____ to _____



The Big Picture

The book defines a computer as a machine that stores, retrieves, and processes data. Before the history starts, learn what's inside one and how it remembers things.

Part 1 · Inside a Computer

Fill in the table as you read.

Who / What	What does it do?	Human comparison
CPU (processor)		
RAM (memory)		
Storage (hard drive / SSD)		
Input devices e.g., keyboard		
Output devices e.g., screen		

Part 2 · Fill It In

Use each word from the word bank once.

bits

UNIVAC

CPU

processes

off

RAM

1. A computer is a machine that stores, retrieves, and _____ data.
2. In 1952, the _____ computer predicted the U.S. presidential election on live TV.
3. The “brain” that follows instructions is the _____.
4. Working memory that is erased when the power goes off is _____.
5. Storage keeps your data even when the computer is turned _____.
6. All data in a computer is stored as _____ — 0s and 1s.

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Check Your Understanding

Part 3 · Timeline

Order the storage technologies from oldest (1) to newest (6). Write the number in the box.

☐

A. Cloud storage becomes common

☐

B. USB flash drive

☐

C. Punched cards store census data

☐

D. Floppy disk

☐

E. Magnetic tape stores data for UNIVAC

☐

F. Compact disc (CD)

Part 4 · Check Your Understanding

1. Which best matches the book's definition of a computer?

- A. Any machine that has a screen
- B. A device that is connected to the Internet
- C. A machine that can only do arithmetic
- D. A machine that stores, retrieves, and processes data

2. Why was the 1952 UNIVAC broadcast a big deal?

- A. It showed millions of TV viewers what a computer could do
- B. It was the first computer ever built
- C. It was the first computer connected to the Internet
- D. It was the first computer sold for homes

3. You save an essay, turn off the laptop, and open it the next day. Where was the essay kept?

- A. RAM
- B. Storage (hard drive or SSD)
- C. The CPU
- D. The monitor

Part 5 · Stories from History

Pick one story or person from this section that surprised you. **Who** was involved, **what** happened, and **why** does it still matter?

Part 6 · Unit 5.1 Connection

The book argues that computing came from thousands of people, not a few "lone geniuses." Name one computer you use every day. Describe one **beneficial** and one **harmful** effect it has on your life.
